

Sophie West



Personal details

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Personal statement

I am a highly motivated teacher and have a lot of passion for my work. I care for my students and their experience in class; so I ensure that I have a flexible and innovative approach to teaching. I personalise the syllabus to suit the interests of the students to ensure a high engagement level. This can take a bit more time, however being as organised as I am, it's no problem to meet deadlines while giving the students a fun class they want to participate in. The energy and optimism I bring to every task means that I work well with others while my high personal motivation ensures I meet all my personal goals.

Teaching qualifications

Trinity CertTESOL

2016

University of Central Lancashire

BA TESOL (Hons) with Korean

2015- 2019

University of Central Lancashire (UK)

2:1

Dissertation (12000 words): *How teaching to different intelligence styles will affect their motivation to learn English*

Modules: TESOL core, Teaching Practice, Teaching Young Learners, Work Experience Module

Skills/Competencies acquired

Ability to assess learners' need through detailed needs analysis and correctly assess their level.

Ability to plan lessons based on learners' levels and needs.

Ability to manage a classroom of mixed ability.

Experience teaching ELT to all CEFR levels Experience (pre-k – adult) e.g. general English, business English

Independent data collection and analysis in the field of ELT. (12000-word dissertation)

Language awareness and analysis for teaching A1 – C2

Experience of designing and developing teaching and learning materials. E.g. Using authentic materials at all CEFR levels/English for academic purposes.

Teaching experience

English Teacher/R&D

PEAI/ISpeak

Korea

December 2024 – Present

At this school I spent a year teaching and conducting research on students' levels and interests before moving across the curriculum development side. Using my knowledge and experience to fix gaps in the materials that I identified while teaching. When teaching, I had textbooks to follow but created projects to compliment the materials. These were usually tailored to the students' interests and incorporated creative and practical skills to use the knowledge acquired from the textbooks and place it in a real-life scenario. In the R&D position, I created a variety of complimentary materials and edited the workbooks the school provided to better suit the level of the students. I worked closely with senior management to create materials that fit their vision and lead several school wide projects using my experience to ensure smooth integration to the classroom.

Senior teacher

Fayston/SSE

Korea

August 2023- September 2024

I joined this school before it opened as part of a very small team. I was the only teacher for the first term and took on a lot of responsibilities that don't usually fall on the senior teacher. Before the school opened, I decorated the classrooms and created displays I thought would be good for the children. I also created the curriculum and timetable, tailored to the students' abilities and interests. I created material bundles and teaching suggestions that were used in classes and provided specific links to useful websites and videos. Along side the R&D responsibilities, I was teaching the majority of the classes in term 1 and assisting other teachers when they needed it. In later classes, I worked closely along side my co-teacher to provide a cohesive teaching style that encouraged independence and social awareness. I listened to her suggestions and ideas and adapted the materials and curriculum accordingly.

English teacher**British Council****Korea****August 2021- August 2023**

While working at the British Council I taught classes of varying ages and abilities; from kindergarten to middle and high school. A large part of my workload (apart from teaching the classes) was planning and personalising classes to cater to my students needs. I created a plan for classes 6 weeks in advance and included regular diagnostic activities to ensure the needs of the students were consistently being met. I enjoyed the freedom of personalising the tasks and projects to suit the interests and skill sets of my students. While here I ran insets based on my previous Montessori experiences, co-planned classes and shared materials with other teachers. I learnt a lot while working here and was encouraged to take risks with new teaching styles and techniques while further developing my personal teaching style.

English teacher**IGarten****Korea****February 2021 – August 2021**

At IGarten, I ran my own class and was the main teacher for the 6-1 students. I was given the opportunity to adapt the timetable and spend longer on subjects that students required more help with. I worked closely with the other teachers and offered advice and help where possible. I received lots of praise about how quickly my students were progressing and their confidence using English. I also ran elementary classes as a part of the afterschool program, which included book classes and grammar classes.

English teacher**BCMA****Korea****October 2019-February 2021**

At BCMA I was working at a bilingual Montessori kindergarten. Working here afforded me many experiences that I hadn't had before, including how individual task-based learning can create a comfortable environment for all the students to gain confidence and flourish. BCMA was my first hagwon (cram school) experience and it taught me how to handle a high work and stress load while also caring for my co-workers and helping their stress too. My ability to prioritise essential work improved. I assisted groups of one to three students (within a larger class of 20) at a time with activities of their choosing and adapted my teaching style to better match their learning styles.

English teacher**Bell English School****England****June 2019 –September 2019**

At Bell I worked as an English teacher and part time activity leader. At Bell I taught using a project-based learning approach which taught me further to incorporate English language into the lesson, allowing easier retention of new vocabulary and grammar. I became more familiar with the GESE structure as I prepared students and assessed which level they should be placed in for these exams. As in previous summer schools I was also involved in the placement testing of students in class and GESE levels.

Skills

Societies – I have been a part of societies since primary school. I have run a few successful clubs and societies through school.

Sports – I have competed at a national level for a few sports, and this taught me how to work hard and to be competitive. I always strive to do the best I can.

Music – I have sung (as part of a choir) at some prestigious locations and played the clarinet during school.

Responsible roles – I have helped to raise my two younger sisters and mentored at school and children moving into higher education. Through these experiences I have nurtured my love for helping people, which is shown in my teaching.

Prizes/Awards – At school I received a couple of rewards for my sports and society work.

Languages spoken – Korean, French (GCSE) and Basic British sign language.

Charity work – I have raised money for a couple of charities through sponsored sports events and volunteered at sports events and other galas.

Travel – I enjoy travel a lot. I find the experience and growth when visiting other places to be incredible and feel that I improve myself each time I do.

Training/CPD

Dyslexia and ESL

February 2022

FutureLearn

Good practice in Autism Education

October 2021

FutureLearn

Teaching Young Learners

October 2018 – December 2018

British council- FutureU

Prison EOSL observation trip

February 2019

UCLan

Hands-up conference: Teaching through diversity

April 2019

UCLan

Carol Read: Teaching through stories

May 2019

Online webinar